STATE OF FLORIDA

DEPARTMENT OF CHILDREN AND FAMILIES

REQUEST FOR QUOTE

Abuse Hotline Contact Center Platform Replacement

DCF RFQ 2627 013

1. PURPOSE

In accordance with Chapter 287, Florida Statutes (F.S.), and Rule Chapter 60A-1, Florida Administrative Code (F.A.C.), the State of Florida, Department of Children and Families (Department), issues this Request for Quotes (RFQ) to Vendors awarded under Alternate Contract Source (ACS), including Data Communications Products and Services, 43220000-NASPO-19-ACS, General Services Administration (GSA), GSA MAS 2023, and the Department of Management Services, Telecommunications/Suncom Contract.

Through this RFQ process, the Department seeks to obtain Quotes (Responses) from prospective Vendors that offer the best value to the Department. “Best value”, as defined in §287.012(4), F.S., means the highest overall value to the state based on factors that include, but are not limited to, price, quality, design, and workmanship.

By responding to this RFQ, Vendors agree to all terms, conditions, and requirements herein. If the Vendor chooses to propose considerations for adjustment to any term, condition, or requirement, such proposed adjustments must be made in the Vendor’s written Response. The Department is not obligated to accept any proposed adjustments, and any proposed adjustments will be used in consideration when determining award(s).

The terms “contract”, “agreement”, and “purchase order” may be interchangeably used throughout this document, all related attachments, exhibits, and referenced documents. These terms collectively refer to the services, terms, and conditions to provide the service/solution that meet the requirements of the **Purchase Order Scope of Work (PMT-57)**, between the Department and the selected Vendor.

2. DESCRIPTION OF PURCHASE

The Department is seeking a qualified Vendor to provide a cloud-based Contact Center Platform solution to replace the Department's existing Abuse Hotline contact center platform. The current environment relies on aging telephony infrastructure and associated technologies that present operational, supportability, scalability, resiliency, and business continuity challenges.

The selected Vendor will provide a comprehensive solution including software licensing, implementation services, system configuration, data and call flow migration, integration services, testing, training, go-live support, and ongoing maintenance and support.

The solution will support the Department's statewide Abuse Hotline operations, including voice, digital communications, call recording, workforce optimization capabilities, reporting and analytics, quality management, business continuity requirements, and future integration needs.

Detailed functional, technical, operational, implementation, security, and performance requirements are contained within the Scope of Work and associated requirements documents.

3. PROCUREMENT OFFICER AND COMMUNICATION

The sole contact point for all communication regarding this RFQ is:

Sally Johns

Procurement Officer

Sally.Johns@myflfamilies.com and cc: hqw.procurement.team.activities@myflfamilies.com

Vendors responding to this solicitation may only contact the Procurement Officer identified above, unless explicitly stated herein, starting from the release of the RFQ, until the Vendor(s) are identified for contract selection. Violation of this provision may be grounds for disqualifying a Vendor.

Communication shall only occur in writing. Any information received through oral communication shall not be binding on the Department and shall not be relied upon by a Vendor.

All emails to the Procurement Officer should contain the solicitation number and title in the subject line.

4. TIMELINE

Below is a list of RFQ event times and dates. The table below contains the Timeline of Events for this solicitation. The dates and times listed as "Anticipated" within the Timeline, are subject to change. The Eastern time zone is in effect for all events listed in the timeline below, unless stated otherwise.

EVENT	DATE	TIME
RFQ Released	July 21, 2026	N/A
Vendor Question(s) Submission Deadline	August 5, 2026	10:00 AM ET
Anticipated Date for Department's Answers to Vendor Questions	August 13, 2026	N/A
Response Due Date	August 27, 2026	10:00 AM ET
Anticipated Award	September 10, 2026	N/A
Anticipated Contract/Purchase Order Start Date	October 1, 2026	N/A

This RFQ is not subject to protest under §120.57(3), F.S.

5. VENDOR QUESTIONS

Vendors will submit all questions pertaining to this RFQ in writing no later than the date and time specified for written questions in **Section 4**.

5.1 Vendors must submit all questions via the electronic acquisition tool this RFQ was released on or by email to the Procurement Officer and email addresses listed in **Section 3**. The Department will not accept questions by telephone, postal mail, hand delivery, or fax. The Department requests all questions be submitted at once, rather than in multiple communications.

5.2 Questions must include at minimum, the following information:

5.2.1 Vendor name.

5.2.2 Section reference pertaining to question.

5.3 The Department will respond to all Vendors who submit questions by the date specified in **Section 4**.

5.4 The Department reserves the right to respond to questions received after the written question submission deadline. It is the sole discretion of the Department to consider questions received after the written questions submission deadline.

6. ADDENDA

If the Department finds it necessary to supplement, modify, or interpret any portion of this RFQ during this posting period, the updates will be issued by written addendum to the advertisement. It is the Vendor's responsibility to check periodically for any information or updates to this RFQ. The

Department bears no responsibility for any resulting impacts associated with a vendor's failure to obtain the information made available.

7. RESPONSE SUBMISSION

7.1 Responses shall be submitted to the Department electronically via the electronic acquisition tool this RFQ was released on or by email to the Procurement Officer and email addresses listed in **Section 3**. Responses must be effective for at least 60 days following the Response Due Date.

7.2 Responses are due by the date and time specified in **Section 4**. Responsibility for timely delivery rests with the Vendor. Vendors should fully acquaint themselves with all aspects of this RFQ to ensure the work is performed in accordance with the terms and conditions herein. No allowances will be made to the selected Vendor due to a lack of knowledge about conditions or requirements nor will the selected Vendor be relieved of any liabilities or obligations.

7.3 The Department reserves the right to accept or reject any or all Responses received and reserves the right to make a selection decision without further discussion of the Responses submitted. The Department reserves the right to make one award, multiple awards, partial awards, or no award, as determined to be in the best interest of the State. Therefore, Responses shall be submitted initially, in the most favorable manner. The Response must be submitted as a PDF file unless specifically noted otherwise. Attachments may be combined with the Response or included as separate attachments.

7.4 It is understood that the Response will become a part of the Department's official procurement file.

7.5 For assistance with using MFMP Sourcing, Vendors may call the MFMP Help Desk at 1-866-352-3776, email vendorhelp@myfloridamarketplace.com, or view the online recorded training, located at: https://www.dms.myflorida.com/business_operations/state_purchasing/myfloridamarketplace/mfmp_vendors/mfmp_vendor_guide.

7.6 Submission through GSA eBuy!, is the Department's preferred method for quote submissions. For more information or assistance with using GSA eBuy!, Vendors may contact the GSA Vendor Support Center, located at: https://vsc.gsa.gov/vsc/, or the Florida Department of Management Services' GSA Concierge Team, pur_gsa_info@dms.myflorida.com.

7.7 The Department shall not be responsible for any costs incurred by a Vendor in the submission of a Response.

8. TRADE SECRETS AND RESPONDENT CLAIMS

8.1 How to Claim Trade Secret Protection

Article 1, section 24, Florida Constitution, guarantees every person access to all public records, and §119.011, F.S., provides a broad definition of "public record." As such, the entirety of the Response is public record and is subject to disclosure unless exempt from disclosure by law. The Department defines "confidential information" as information that is trade secret as defined in §688.002, F.S., or otherwise confidential or exempt from disclosure under Florida or federal law.

If the Vendor considers any portion of the Response to be confidential information, the Vendor shall then submit two copies of the Response. In both copies, any portion of the Response considered confidential information shall be clearly labeled within the text of the Response as "CONFIDENTIAL". For each portion of the Response that is labeled "CONFIDENTIAL", the Vendor shall provide a written statement of the basis for exemption applicable to each provision identified by the Vendor as "confidential", including citation to a protection created by statute, and state with particularity the reasons the provision is confidential.

The original copy shall be unredacted and labeled on the cover of the Response as “Confidential Copy”. The redacted copy shall redact all the confidential information and be labeled on the cover of the Response as “Redacted Copy”.

8.2 Department not Obligated to Defend Vendor Claims

By submitting a Response, the Vendor agrees to protect, defend, and indemnify the Department for all claims arising from or relating to the Vendor’s determination that the redacted portions of its Response are confidential information. If a Vendor fails to submit a Redacted Copy in accordance with this solicitation, the Department is authorized to produce the entire material submitted to the Department in response to a demand for discovery or disclosure of these records or a public records request.

9. RESPONSE STRUCTURE

The Vendor must submit the Response in accordance with **Section 7**, clearly labeling each copy of the Response with “Confidential Copy” and “Redacted Copy” (if applicable). The Department reserves the right to reject any Response that does not: properly address the requirements; fails to include the requested information; or deviates from the requirements of this RFQ in any manner. Responses must include the following sections in the order prescribed:

Unless otherwise specified, page limitations apply only to the narrative content of the applicable Response section and do not include the cover page, table of contents, divider pages, completed Department forms, resumes of proposed personnel, organizational charts, diagrams, project schedules, pricing forms, or other required attachments.

9.1 Cover Page

9.1.1 Contact Information

Identify the solicitation information (including solicitation number and title), the Vendor’s primary point of contact (including name, title, email, address and direct telephone number), corporation, corporate physical address, email address, physical address if different than corporate address, corporate Federal Employer Identification Number, and E-Verify Number.

9.1.2 Redacted Response Statement

The Vendor shall submit a statement indicating that a Redacted Copy is included, or is not included, with the Vendor’s Response.

9.2 Introductory Letter and Executive Summary

The introductory letter must include an executive summary that demonstrates the Vendor’s understanding of the needs of this RFQ and summarize how the Vendor’s solution will meet the Department’s needs.

9.3 Service Capability (Limited to 15 pages)

The Vendor’s Response should demonstrate the Vendor’s capability in providing processes, approaches, and tools to perform requested services described in **Purchase Order Scope of Work (PMT-57).**

The Department will evaluate the Vendor's demonstrated experience, technical capability, staffing resources, and overall ability to successfully provide the requested solution.

9.3.1 The Vendor shall demonstrate its capability to provide a mature, enterprise-class cloud contact center platform supporting:

- Inbound and outbound voice communications.

- Interactive Voice Response (IVR).
- Automatic Call Distribution (ACD).
- Omnichannel communications.
- Call recording and screen recording.
- Workforce management and scheduling capabilities.
- Quality management and performance monitoring.
- Reporting, dashboards, and analytics.
- High availability and disaster recovery.
- Security and compliance requirements.
- Integration capabilities with third-party systems.

9.3.2 The Vendor shall describe staffing, organizational structure, implementation resources, support resources, escalation procedures, project governance approach, and any relevant certifications or accreditations. Vendors shall identify key personnel proposed for the project and describe their experience implementing similar contact center solutions for government agencies or large enterprise environments.

9.4 Project Approach (Limited to 20 pages)

The Vendor's Response should detail the Vendor's Project Approach to meet the requirements as described in **Purchase Order Scope of Work (PMT-57).** Vendor must address proposed approaches or models, implementation plans (including timelines and activities), barriers or challenges, staff identification, resume/bio of key personnel, industry standards (such as required accreditations, certifications, etc.), and best practices.

The Department will evaluate the Vendor's proposed implementation methodology, project management approach, migration strategy, and ability to successfully transition the Department to the proposed solution.

9.4.1 Vendors shall provide a detailed implementation approach, including:

- Project initiation and planning.
- Requirements validation.
- Solution design.
- Configuration and customization.
- Integration activities.
- Testing strategy.
- User Acceptance Testing support.
- Training approach.
- Cutover and go-live strategy.
- Post-implementation stabilization and support.

9.4.2 Vendors shall describe how their proposed solution addresses the Department's business and technical requirements, including:

- Cloud architecture and hosting model.
- Business continuity and disaster recovery.
- Security controls and compliance.
- Call routing and IVR capabilities.
- Workforce optimization capabilities.
- Reporting and analytics.
- Call and screen recording.
- System administration and configuration tools.

- Integration framework and APIs.
- Scalability and future growth.
- Migration approach from the Department's current environment.
- Training and knowledge transfer.

9.5 Prior Similar Projects

Vendors shall submit details regarding at least three (3) similar projects performed within the past five (5) years. For purposes of this RFQ, a “similar project” means the implementation, migration, modernization, operation, or ongoing support of a mission-critical contact center platform or environment supporting two hundred (200) or more agents and requiring 24 hours per day, 7 days per week, 365 days per year availability, rapid incident response, urgent call triage, escalation, continuity of operations, and service levels appropriate for time-sensitive public safety, child welfare, human services, crisis response, or similarly regulated functions. For each project, Vendors should identify the customer, implementation dates, project scope, services provided, number of supported agents or users, and a customer point of contact for reference purposes.

9.6 Cost Proposal

The Vendor will use **Purchase Order Scope of Work (PMT-57), Attachment B: Cost Proposal**, to provide a not-to-exceed price for the services described in the **Purchase Order Scope of Work (PMT-57).** The pricing quoted by the Vendor shall not exceed the approved pricing available under the Vendor’s contract source. The Department reserves the right to negotiate lower rates with the selected Vendor(s).

10. Evaluation Criteria and Selection Methodology

The Department will evaluate Responses from responsible and responsive Vendors to determine the Response that represents the best value to the State. Evaluation will be based on the criteria identified below. The Department reserves the right to request clarifications, verify information submitted, and consider any information that demonstrates the Vendor's ability to successfully perform the requirements of the Purchase Order Scope of Work.

Evaluators shall assign scores to each of the responses received by the Department based on the considerations detailed for each criterion.

The assignment of an individual score must be based upon the following description of the point scores, unless otherwise noted for a specific criterion:

The response demonstrates or describes	Category	Assign points
A comprehensive, well-supported, and highly responsive approach that clearly exceeds the criterion.	Superior	4
A clear, capable, and responsive approach that fully addresses the criterion with only minor weaknesses.	Good	3
An acceptable approach that addresses the criterion but contains notable weaknesses or lacks sufficient detail.	Adequate	2
A limited or weak approach that only minimally addresses the criterion and has significant deficiencies.	Poor	1
Does not address the criterion or demonstrates an inadequate understanding of the requirement.	Insufficient	0

10.1. Responses will be evaluated based on the following criteria:

Evaluation Criterion	Description	Score (0-4) Superior (4), Good (3), Adequate (2), Poor (1), Insufficient (0)
Service Capability	Demonstrated capability to provide the required solution, including the maturity of the proposed platform, staffing, organizational experience, technical resources, and ability to meet the Department's operational requirements.	
Project Approach	Quality, completeness, and feasibility of the proposed implementation, migration, project management, testing, training, transition, and support approach.	
Prior Similar Projects	Relevant experience implementing and supporting comparable contact center solutions of similar size, complexity, and operational requirements.	
Cost	Overall proposed pricing and value considering the proposed solution, implementation approach, and ongoing services.	

10.2. Evaluation Process

The Department's Evaluation Team will independently review each Response against the evaluation criteria. The Department may request written clarifications from Vendors to assist in the evaluation. Clarifications shall not be used to materially modify or supplement a Response. The Department may also verify information contained within a Response through customer references, publicly available information, or other information obtained during the evaluation process.

The Department intends to award to the responsible and responsive Vendor(s) whose Response(s) are determined to provide the best value to the State.

10.3 Department Rights

The Department reserves the right to:

- Determine whether a Vendor is responsible and responsive.
- Reject any or all Responses.
- Waive minor irregularities.
- Request clarifications.
- Make one award, multiple awards, partial awards, or no award, as determined to be in the best interest of the State.

- Conduct discussions, demonstrations, interviews, or presentations with one or more Vendors if determined to be in the best interest of the Department.

11. Term

The anticipated start date of the Purchase Order is October 1, 2026. The anticipated duration of this contract is three years with funding beyond year one contingent upon legislative appropriation. Renewal, if any, shall comply with §287.057(14), F.S.

12. RFQ ATTACHMENTS

12.1 Purchase Order Terms and Conditions (PMT-47)

12.2 Purchase Order Scope of Work (PMT-57)

12.3 Attachment C Hotline Contact Center Requirements Spreadsheet

12.4 Attachment D Application and Data Security and Confidentiality

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